supporting the notion of a long-term alliance with non-Western states to constrain the West and become self-sufficient. The same Russian doctrine stated that Russian nationalists must call for military alliances with non-Western states, especially China, India, and Iran (Tsigankov 2009). This is because Russia never believed in the West or felt that there was a possibility of normalcy between Russia and the West over some time. The regular frictions on various issues were also another reason for Russia to move away from any Western alliance. That is why the pragmatist wants Russia to establish relations with non-Western countries.

Ideologists

The Chinese discourse of the ideologists within Russia encouraged a nationalist and anti-Western ideology and aspired for a unique development model. The Communist Party of Russia and the Eurasianists advocated close alliances with China and Iran to bring Russia back to its cultural roots (Tsigankov 2009). They also regarded Western influences on Russia's sovereignty as dangerous. This group promoted creating a Eurasian coalition, with China’s help, to create a meaningful counterbalance against the West. Thus, with China’s support, the United States would be evacuated from Russia’s traditionally influenced areas, and a Russia–Chinese model of state and culture-centered development would emerge (ibid.). Thus, there are three essential factors behind Russia’s shift toward China. They are:

- With the rapid rise of China’s economic growth,
- The need to break away from US unilateralism in global affairs,
- A relative weakening of Russia’s stature in international relations (Tsigankov 2009).

And Russia needed economic support from other than Western countries. In this process, China had given them one option. The pressure from the West in the form of NATO eastward expansion was such that it had to build alternative power centers globally. The gradual evolution of Russia–China relations could be seen through the cumulative results of growing trade convergence and several intersections in global affairs policy.

Early Attempts at a Partnership with China